



Department of Economics
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February 18, 2026

Search Committee
Department of Economics
Perdue School of Business
Salisbury University
Salisbury, MD

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the tenure track Assistant Professor position in Macroeconomics at Salisbury University. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics. I am enthusiastic about contributing to a department that values high quality undergraduate teaching alongside an active research agenda.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households.

In my job market paper, I calibrate a life cycle heterogeneous agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns. I find a hump shaped relationship for trust and returns (consistent with the literature) and characterize the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to frame research strategies and design modeling approaches, execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro data sets, and translate results into clear and rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences. I am committed to maintaining an active research agenda that leads to peer reviewed publications consistent with AACSB expectations.

I would welcome the opportunity to teach Principles of Macroeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, and electives such as Money and Banking, International Economics, or Financial Economics. My research background provides a strong foundation for explaining monetary policy, financial markets, and global economic dynamics in a clear and structured manner. In the classroom, I emphasize intuition, analytical reasoning, and practical application. I value student mentoring and advising and enjoy working closely with undergraduates as they develop their academic and professional goals.

I am enthusiastic about remaining in Maryland and contributing to Salisbury University's Perdue School of Business. I am fully committed to in person teaching and advising and to supporting the

intellectual life of the department through service and collaboration. The nine credit hour teaching load aligns well with my experience and my commitment to balancing high quality instruction with sustained research productivity.

I believe I would be a strong fit for this role because:

1. My research specialization in macroeconomics aligns directly with the department's teaching needs.
2. I am committed to excellence in undergraduate instruction, mentoring, and advising.
3. I maintain an active research agenda consistent with peer reviewed publication standards.

Thank you very much for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to the Department of Economics at Salisbury University.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards